Knowledge organiser (SUMMIT) — Analysing a practitioner without copying the page

Pathway: SUMMIT · Week 3 Part 1 · Big question: How do we conduct rigorous visual analysis of a practitioner's work through annotated studies rather than biography copying?

Core studio focus

Family: Identity and studio log

Big question: How do we conduct rigorous visual analysis of a practitioner's work through annotated studies rather than biography copying?

• Analyse a practitioner's artwork using the four-lens framework: Form, Process, Contrast, and Symbolic intent.

• Execute two focused analytical studies (a 5-value tonal structure map and a close-up mark-making transcription).

• Synthesise your visual findings into an original thumbnail concept that adapts the practitioner's method to your own identity theme.

Essential vocabulary

• visual analysis: Examining how an artwork is constructed visually (tone, composition, mark-making) rather than copying biographical facts.

• tonal map: A simplified 3-to-5 value thumbnail that reveals where the artist placed darks, mid-tones, and lights.

• transcription: A focused study of a small section made to reverse-engineer the layer order and tool marks.

• intent: The meaning, mood, or visual impact the practitioner aimed to communicate.

• adaptation: Taking a structural or technical principle from a study and re-inventing it for your own subject.

Three-step studio method

Step 1: Draw the 3-value Tonal map (Box 1): I squint at the exemplar print to blur details and block in the dark, mid, and light zones in Box 1, noting the bright halo around the head.

Step 2: Reverse-engineer the mark recipe (Box 2): Using a viewfinder, I transcribe a 6 cm square in Box 2, annotating the three layers: 1. Warm wash, 2. Oil-pastel cross-hatching, 3. Heavy ink contour.

Step 3: Design my Personal adaptation (Box 3): In box 3, I apply that exact 3-tone halo plan and 3-layer recipe to my own architectural/symbolic identity motif.